

MY LOCS THRIVE

MLT

A CALM PLACE TO BEGIN

The Gentle Starter Guide

A practical introduction for considering locs or navigating the first stage of the journey.

A gentle reminder: You do not need perfect hair knowledge. You need a healthy foundation, curiosity, patience and the will to begin.

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Begin with better questions.

Locs are a long-term hair-care choice, not a shortcut to never thinking about your hair again. Use these prompts to bring your real life into the decision.

- ☐ What do I hope locs will make simpler?
- ☐ How do I feel about visible change and imperfect stages?
- ☐ What maintenance time and cost can I realistically sustain?
- ☐ Do I want professional maintenance, self-maintenance or both?
- ☐ Which work, exercise, swimming or headwear needs should I discuss?

Keep in mind: You do not need perfect certainty. You need enough information to understand the commitment and know where to ask for help.

My reasons and questions

Learn the language before the consultation.

A useful consultation should explain the options, why a method may suit your goals and what the maintenance process involves.

Common starting approaches	Questions to ask
Comb coils Two-strand twists Braids or plaits Interlocking Instant loc techniques Freeform or semi-freeform approaches	Why does this method suit my goals and hair? How will the sections affect future loc size? What is the early cleansing guidance? What maintenance technique and timing are expected? What is the likely cost? What happens if a loc loosens?

Remember: No single method is universally best. A qualified loctician should explain why a method fits your goals, not simply tell you that it does.

Consultation notes

A simple care checklist.

The first month is less about making starter locs look finished and more about allowing a new structure and routine to settle.

- ☐ Save your locician's method-specific cleansing and maintenance instructions.
- ☐ Take clear starting photographs for your own reference.
- ☐ Protect locs from avoidable lint and friction while sleeping.
- ☐ Avoid repeatedly twisting or handling roots for a freshly maintained look.
- ☐ Ask before adding products just in case.
- ☐ Write down discomfort, scalp changes or questions instead of guessing.
- ☐ Confirm the next professional check-in if that is part of your plan.

What I noticed

Release the pressure to do it perfectly.

A kinder journey begins when unrealistic expectations are replaced with useful, honest information.

MYTH	A MORE HONEST VIEW
Locs mean no maintenance.	They may reduce daily manipulation, but cleansing, observation and a sustainable maintenance plan still matter.
Every starter loc should develop at the same pace.	Texture, location, method and routine can create variation across one head.
Frizz means failure.	Frizz and loose hairs can be part of an evolving starter-loc stage. Method-specific concerns belong with your locician.
Pain proves a style is neat or secure.	You do not need to accept significant pain. Ask for excessive tension to be adjusted.

One expectation I am ready to release

Know who to ask.

Healthy foundations include knowing when a question belongs with a qualified loctician and when a health concern belongs with a clinician.

A qualified loctician	An appropriate clinician
Method selection, installation, parting, unraveling, retwisting or interlocking, product build-up and maintenance technique.	Persistent or worsening itching, scaling or inflammation; pain, sores, pus or marked swelling; a spreading rash; sudden or patchy hair loss; or concerns that health or medication changes may be affecting your hair.

Important: This guide cannot diagnose a scalp or hair condition. Do not delay urgent or necessary care because of online information.

My support plan

Loctician or consultation contact

Questions I want to ask

Grow healthy locs. Enjoy the process.

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